

CAREERLAUNCH PRODUCT ROADMAP

Prioritization Using the RICE Framework

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1. Introduction

This document presents the prioritized product roadmap for CareerLaunch, a job-search platform built for college students, fresh graduates, and career switchers in India. It applies the RICE framework — Reach, Impact, Confidence, and Effort — to a brainstormed set of thirteen candidate features, translating qualitative product judgment into a transparent, defensible sequencing of build priorities.

The roadmap is organized into three horizons: Now (MVP, build first), Next (3–6 months), and Later (future consideration). Each horizon reflects a deliberate trade-off between reach, user impact, delivery confidence, and engineering effort, rather than a simple list of desired features.

2. Product Vision

CareerLaunch exists to close the gap between ambition and access for early-career job seekers in India — a population that is large, mobile-first, and chronically underserved by fragmented, low-trust job platforms. The vision is a single, trustworthy destination where a final-year student, a recent graduate, and a mid-career switcher can each find a path suited to their specific stage: discovery for the explorer, precision for the urgent job-seeker, and recognition of transferable skill for the switcher.

Over time, CareerLaunch aims to become the system of record for an early-career job search in India: the place users start their search, track every application, and return to when they're ready for what's next.

3. Feature Brainstorming

Before prioritization, the team brainstormed a broad set of candidate features spanning the full job-search journey — from onboarding through application, preparation, and long-term engagement. Thirteen features emerged as the most consistently requested and product-relevant, grouped here by journey stage:

Core Funnel

- Profile creation & onboarding
- Job search + filters
- Apply button (one-tap apply)
- Verified / freshness-checked listings
- Application status tracking

Matching & Personalization

- Eligibility-aware matching (“Fresher Match” / “Switcher Match”)
- Personalized job recommendations
- Career-switcher mode

Preparation & Differentiation

- Resume builder (templates)
- AI resume tailoring / scoring
- Mock interview practice
- Referral request tool
- Video cover letter

Each feature was carried forward into RICE scoring rather than prioritized by instinct alone, ensuring the roadmap reflects evidence and trade-offs rather than the loudest stakeholder in the room.

4. RICE Prioritization

RICE Score = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort. The table below scores all thirteen candidate features, sorted in the order they appear in the brainstorm; the Product Roadmap section that follows regroups them by priority horizon.

Feature	Reach (users/qtr)	Impact (1-3)	Confidence	Effort (p-wks)	RICE
Profile creation & onboarding	10,000	2	95%	8	2,375
Job search + filters	10,000	3	90%	10	2,700
Apply button (one-tap apply)	9,000	3	90%	6	4,050
Verified / fresh listings	9,500	2	85%	7	2,307
Application status tracking	7,000	2	80%	6	1,867
Eligibility-aware matching	8,000	3	70%	12	1,400
Resume builder (templates)	8,500	2	90%	8	1,913
AI resume tailoring/scoring	6,500	2	65%	9	939
Mock interview practice	5,500	3	60%	14	707
Personalized recommendations	7,500	2	60%	12	750
Referral request tool	4,000	2	75%	8	750
Career-switcher mode	2,500	3	65%	10	488
Video cover letter	1,200	1	50%	7	86

Top 3: Why They Lead

The apply button tops the list despite moderate reach because its effort is low and its impact is universal — every user who applies touches it, and removing friction here directly drives the core conversion metric. Job search and filters and profile creation follow closely: both sit near 100% reach with very high confidence, since they are well-understood, low-risk patterns that the rest of the product depends on entirely. These three are not prioritized because they are novel; they are prioritized because nothing else functions without them.

Bottom 3: Why They Wait

Video cover letter scores lowest by a wide margin: reach is small, impact is marginal even for likely users, and confidence is low, since there is no evidence that entry-level recruiters in India weight video submissions. Career-switcher mode is high-impact for the users it serves, but reach is structurally limited — switchers are a minority of the base — making it a strong Later candidate rather than an MVP feature. Mock interview practice carries genuine value but also the highest effort on the list, and

moderate confidence, since the feedback-quality bar required to make it credible has not yet been validated.

5. Product Roadmap

Regrouping the RICE-scored features by priority horizon produces the build sequence below: Now features anchor the Q1 MVP, Next features extend the product across Q2–Q3, and Later features remain on the backlog pending stronger reach or confidence signals.

Feature	RICE Score	Priority	Quarter	Status
Apply button (one-tap apply)	4,050	Now	Q1	To build
Job search + filters	2,700	Now	Q1	To build
Profile creation & onboarding	2,375	Now	Q1	To build
Verified / fresh listings	2,307	Now	Q1	To build
Resume builder (templates)	1,913	Now	Q1	To build
Application status tracking	1,867	Next	Q2	Planned
Eligibility-aware matching	1,400	Next	Q2	Planned
AI resume tailoring/scoring	939	Next	Q3	Planned
Personalized recommendations	750	Next	Q3	Planned
Referral request tool	750	Next	Q3	Planned
Mock interview practice	707	Later	Q4	Backlog
Career-switcher mode	488	Later	Q4	Backlog
Video cover letter	86	Later	Q4	Backlog

6. Strategic Narrative

The NOW tranche — profile creation, job search and filters, the apply button, verified listings, and the resume builder — is prioritized because each scores highest on RICE: near-universal reach, low-to-moderate effort, and high confidence given well-understood interaction patterns. These five features also form the product's load-bearing wall; every later capability, from eligibility matching to personalized recommendations, depends on this foundation already being in place.

Shipping this tranche tests two core product hypotheses. First, that removing friction from the apply flow through one-tap apply and verified, freshness-checked listings will measurably increase applications submitted per active user. Second, that a credible, guided resume builder reduces drop-off between profile creation and a user's first completed application.

Features move from NEXT to NOW once two conditions are satisfied: the underlying infrastructure they depend on is stable in production, and early usage data raises their confidence score. Most NEXT-tier features — eligibility-aware matching, application status tracking — currently sit at 65 to 80 percent confidence precisely because we lack the behavioral data needed to validate them further.

Success after three months looks like a working core funnel: a healthy rate of completed profiles, active weekly searches, verified applications submitted, and clear early signal on exactly where users stall next.

7. Conclusion

The RICE framework converts a long, well-intentioned feature wishlist into a sequenced, defensible roadmap. The Now tranche is deliberately unglamorous — onboarding, search, apply, trust, and resume tools — because these are the features every other ambition in the product depends on. The Next and Later tranches are not rejections; they are features waiting on the data and infrastructure that the Now tranche will produce.

As CareerLaunch moves through its first three quarters, this roadmap should be revisited each quarter with fresh usage data — reach, confidence, and even effort estimates will shift as the team learns, and the RICE scores should shift with them.